



How to Ask a Good Question



Why It Matters

Coaches are here to give you focused, expert guidance. The more specific your question, the more useful their answer.



How to Shape Your Question

Use the 1-3-1 framework to get focused, useful answers from your coaches.

1 One context statement

Briefly explain your situation. One or two sentences maximum.

2 Three approaches you're considering

What are the ways you're considering tackling it? Show your coach you've already thought about it.

3 The solution you're leaning toward

What are you leaning toward and why? This is where the coach adds value by refining your thinking, not doing it for you.

SEE THE DIFFERENCE

✗ Without 1-3-1:

"I'm applying to a fintech startup that has some Cornell alumni on the team. I don't have much finance experience but I'm really interested in breaking into the space. I've done some data science research and product internships. What's the strongest framing for myself and should I lead with my open source contributions, my university research, or my startup experience? Also should I reach out cold or try to get a warm intro first? Here's the company link."

✓ With 1-3-1:

1. CONTEXT:

I'm targeting a software engineering role at a fintech startup and want to reach out to a Cornell alum on the team.

2. APPROACHES YOU'RE CONSIDERING

I'm considering leading with my open source contributions, my university data science research, or my product internship experience at an early stage startup.

3. WHAT YOU'RE LEANING TOWARD

I'm leaning toward the open source angle since it's the most technically relevant to what they build, but I'm not sure if the startup experience might resonate more with an early stage company.



Where to Take Your Question

Once your question is structured using 1-3-1, here's where it belongs:

- For general interview prep, resume, LinkedIn, job search strategy, **post in Skool or add them to the OH Zoom registration form**
- For advice on preparing for a specific company or role you're targeting, **submit a flex mock pre-submission form**
- For logistical or scheduling questions, **email help@manazir.org**
- Not sure where it belongs? Email **help@manazir.org** and we'll point you in the right direction



One Hard Boundary

Coaches cannot refer you directly to companies or contacts. Focus on building your own network using the strategies covered in the program.



Closing Thought

Good questions are a skill. The students who get the most out of their coaching sessions are the ones who come prepared, specific, and ready to act on the answer.